

HARISUMIRAN · COLUMBUS

Pickleball Tournament

Official Visual Rulebook · Doubles · Round Robin → Knockout

24

TEAMS

6

GROUPS OF 4

16

KNOCKOUT SPOTS

1

CHAMPION

Mixed-level doubles · Each team = 1 Intermediate + 1 Beginner player · June 6, 2026, Columbus

1 Tournament Format

This is a **mixed-level doubles tournament**. Every team pairs one **Intermediate** player with one **Beginner** player, drawn at random. The event runs in two phases:



Phase 1 — Group Stage (Round Robin)

- ▶ 24 teams are divided into **6 groups of 4**.
- ▶ Each team plays the other three teams in its group once (**6 matches per group**, 36 group matches in all).
- ▶ A **win earns 2 points**; a loss earns 0.
- ▶ The **top 2 teams** from every group advance automatically — 12 teams.

★ Wildcards — the final 4 spots

- ▶ The **third-place team** from each group (six in total) competes for the last 4 knockout places.
- ▶ These six teams are **ranked by points**; the **best 4 advance** as wildcards — making 16 teams.
- ▶ If a points tie decides who takes the 4th wildcard, the tied teams play a **tie-breaker match**.

Phase 2 — Knockout & Seeding

- ▶ 16 qualifiers enter a single-elimination bracket: **Round of 16** → **Quarterfinals** → **Semifinals** → **Final**.
- ▶ **Seeding**: group winners are ranked by points and drawn against the **weakest wildcards first**; remaining teams are seeded by points.
- ▶ **No two teams from the same group** can meet in the Round of 16.
- ▶ Lose once and you're out. Win and you advance until one team lifts the trophy.

Group Tie-Breakers (in order)

#	TIE-BREAKER	HOW IT'S DECIDED
1	Points	2 per win — most points ranks higher
2	Head-to-head	Winner of the match between the tied teams
3	Point differential	Points scored minus points conceded
4	Tie-breaker match	If still level for a qualifying spot, play it off

Be on time. Report to your court within **5 minutes** of being called. A no-show may forfeit the game. A short 2-minute warm-up is allowed before each match if the schedule permits.

2 Scoring & The Court

11

POINTS · GROUP & EARLY
KNOCKOUT

15

POINTS · SEMIFINALS & FINAL

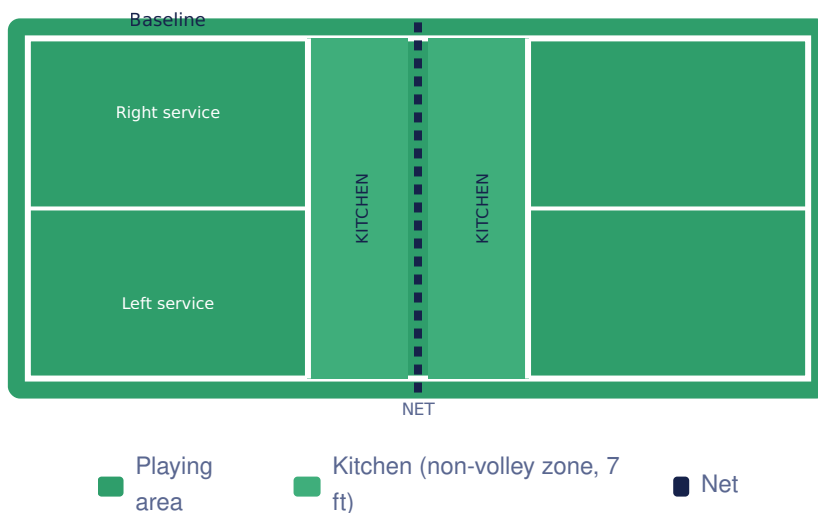
2

WIN-BY MARGIN

How Scoring Works

- ▶ Group and early knockout matches are a **single game to 11**, win by 2.
- ▶ Semifinals and the Final are a **single game to 15**, win by 2.
- ▶ **Rally scoring** is used for this tournament: a point is awarded on every rally, no matter who served. (Confirm with organizers if traditional serve-only scoring is preferred.)
- ▶ Always **call the score out loud** before serving so both teams agree.

The Court



A pickleball court is **20 ft x 44 ft** (same as doubles badminton). The net is **36 inches** high at the sidelines and **34 inches** at the center.

3 Serving & The Kitchen

Serving Rules

- ▶ Serve **underhand** — paddle contact below the waist, with an upward arc.
- ▶ Serve **diagonally** (cross-court) into the opponent's service box.
- ▶ Keep **both feet behind the baseline** at the moment of contact.
- ▶ The serve must clear the kitchen and its line to be good.
- ▶ **One serve attempt** per server. A serve that clips the net and lands in is played (no lets).

↔ The Two-Bounce Rule

- ▶ The receiving team **must let the serve bounce** before returning it.
- ▶ The serving team **must let that return bounce** before hitting it.
- ▶ After these two bounces, either team may volley (out of the air) — but only from outside the kitchen.

Why it matters

The two-bounce rule keeps the game fair and rallies longer by stopping teams from rushing the net to smash the return.

The Kitchen (Non-Volley Zone)

- ▶ The 7-foot zone on each side of the net is the **kitchen**. You may **not volley** while standing in it or touching its line.
- ▶ You **may** step into the kitchen to play a ball that has already **bounced** — but you must exit before volleying again.
- ▶ If your **momentum** carries you (or anything you're wearing/holding) into the kitchen right after a volley, it's a fault.

⚠ Common Faults

FAULT	WHAT HAPPENS
Ball hit out of bounds or into the net	Point to the other team
Volleying in / touching the kitchen line	Point to the other team
Breaking the two-bounce rule	Point to the other team
Ball bounces twice before return	Point to the other team
Player or paddle touches the net / post	Point to the other team

4 Etiquette, Conduct & Day-of

Sportsmanship & Line Calls

- ▶ Call your own lines **honestly**. When in doubt, the ball is **IN** — the benefit goes to your opponent.
- ▶ If there's a genuine dispute with no agreement, **replay the rally**.
- ▶ No coaching during a live rally. Keep a good pace — be ready to serve and receive.
- ▶ Encourage your beginner partner. This is a **mixed-level event** built on teamwork.
- ▶ **Paddle-tap** at the net after every match, win or lose.

Player Checklist

- ▶ Court shoes with good grip
- ▶ Water bottle & a towel
- ▶ Arrive early; know your group
- ▶ Check the schedule between matches

Quick Rules Recap

- ▶ Serve underhand & cross-court
- ▶ Let it bounce twice to start
- ▶ Stay out of the kitchen on volleys
- ▶ 11 to win (15 in semis & final), win by 2

Organizer Authority

- ▶ Organizers' decisions on scheduling, tie-breaks, eligibility, and conduct are **final**.
- ▶ Unsporting behavior may result in a warning, point penalty, or disqualification.

Spirit of the tournament: Harisumiran Columbus 2026 is a friendly community event. Play hard, play fair, lift up the first-timers, and make sure everyone leaves the court smiling. Good luck to all 24 teams!